NAVE

Getting started: a reverb suite for Ableton Live



On a track for one sound, or on a return so many tracks share one space

Nave is a reverb for anything: twenty-nine types, from the air around a dry vocal to a cathedral, plates, springs, clouds, shimmer and choirs, gated and reverse shapes, tape echo and tails tuned to a key. You **search** for a type by name or by sound, then **shape** it with the same set of knobs whatever it is, and the **TAIL** display shows you the reverb you've actually made. This guide gets it into Live in a couple of minutes, then shows you round.

INSERT

On a track

Drop Nave on the track and turn **MIX** to taste. Good when one sound wants its own space: a vocal plate, a drum room, a guitar spring.

SEND

On a return track

Put Nave on a return, **MIX** at 100%, **KEEP MIX** on, and turn up each track's Send. Many tracks in one room, and only one reverb using the CPU.

You'll need

- Ableton Live 11 or 12 (any edition that loads VST3 plug-ins).
- Nave built and installed. Building it copies **Nave.vst3** into ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3 for you; a release download goes in the same folder.
- Something to put it on: a vocal, a drum loop, a synth, a guitar.

> **Long tails are loud tails.** A 20-second cloud at 100% MIX builds up. Start with MIX around 30% on a track, or with the return track's fader down, and bring it up.

Set up

1 Let Live see Nave

Open **Live → Settings** (Cmd+comma) and choose the **Plug-Ins** tab. Turn on **Use VST3 Plug-In System Folders**, then press **Rescan**. In the browser, open **Plug-Ins**. Nave is under **Taddei**.

2 On a track

Drag Nave onto a track and play. It opens on **Start Here**, a warm concert hall at 30% MIX. The meters by INPUT and OUTPUT move, and the bar at the right of the **TAIL** display shows the reverb as it plays.

3 On a return track

Drag Nave onto a return track (A or B). Turn **MIX** to 100%, or load **Send: Hall** or **Send: Plate**, and switch on **KEEP MIX** so trying other presets doesn't bring the dry sound back. Turn up the **Send** knob on each track you want in the room.

4 Find a type

Click the type's name. A search box opens over the panel: type a few letters and pick. Search by name (**plate**), by place (**church**), by use (**drums**, **vocal**) or by sound (**dark**, **80s**, **octave**). Arrow keys move, Return picks, Escape closes. The category buttons narrow the list. Picking a type sets SPACE and CHARACTER to where it sounds best; the rest stays put.

5 Shape it

Work left to right. **DECAY** and **SIZE** set how long and how big; **PRE-DELAY** keeps the dry sound in front. Then **TONE** (dark or bright) and **LOW END** (how much bass hangs around), and **LOW CUT** to keep the mix clean. Watch the TAIL display: it's re-measured every time you move something, and the RT60 readings tell you how long the whole tail, its lows and its highs really last.

6 Make room for the dry sound

On vocals, turn up **DUCK**: the reverb dips while you sing and blooms in the gaps. On drums, **GATE** cuts the tail when the hit is over. **RELEASE** sets how fast both let go. Try the **Ducked Vocal Hall** and **Gated Snare** presets.

7 Hold it

Press **HOLD** and the tail stops decaying. With **INFINITE** what you play keeps adding to it; with **FREEZE** it's sealed and you play over it. HOLD is a host parameter: map it to a footswitch or a pad, or automate it, for pads that hang until you let go.

> **Nothing happening?** Check MIX isn't at 0% and the type isn't Swell waiting for a new note. If GATE is up, the light by it shows whether it's open: turn GATE down if it's shutting too soon. If the tail suddenly stops, HOLD may be on in FREEZE with nothing held.

The panel



Section	What it does
Header	PRESET (click for the list or to search; step with < >; a * means changed), SAVE, TIPS.
TYPE	The reverb type: click to search, < > to step. HOLD, with INFINITE or FREEZE.
TAIL	The impulse response of the settings you have now: the whole tail (amber), its lows (blue) and highs (lavender), and their decay times. The bar on the right is the reverb playing.
SPACE	DECAY, SIZE, PRE-DELAY (SYNC for note values), DIFFUSION (grainy to smooth), EARLY (the first reflections).
CHARACTER	Up to three knobs and a choice that belong to the type: BUILD and DISTANCE for rooms, SHIFT for shimmer, VOWEL for choir, SHAPE for nonlinear, HEADS for tape...
MOTION	DEPTH and RATE move the reverb's delay lines: a little is natural air, a lot is chorus.
TONE	TONE and LOW END: how long the highs and lows last. MID, LOW CUT, HIGH CUT: what comes out. Never the dry sound.
DYNAMICS	DUCK (dips the reverb while you play), GATE (cuts it when you stop), RELEASE.
MIX	INPUT, MIX (50% is both at full; 100% is reverb only), WIDTH, OUTPUT, KEEP MIX.

> Turn on **TIPS** and hold the mouse over anything: every knob says what it does, and the CHARACTER knobs say what they do for the type you've picked.

The types

Twenty-nine of them in six families. The words below are a few that find them in the search.

VOCAL DRUMS DARK BRIGHT HUGE 80S OCTAVE CHURCH GUITAR PAD VINTAGE TAPE BACKWARDS KEY

ROOMS

Ambience: just the air around a sound.

Studio Room: natural and flattering on anything.

Live Room: bigger, harder walls, a bright splash.

Drum Room: short and punchy; SMASH crushes it.

Club: a lively venue, bass hanging around.

Chamber: dense, smooth concrete chamber.

Reflections: move the source in a small room with X and Y.

HALLS

Small Hall: warm and quick to bloom.

Concert Hall: spacious and warm; the all-rounder.

Arena: huge, enveloping and booming.

Cathedral: stone, height, and an ECHO off the far wall.

PLATES

Plate: fast, dense and smooth, LARGE or SMALL.

Vocal Plate: airy top, light bottom.

Vintage Plate: darker, with DRIVE in front.

SPRINGS

Spring: one to three springs; DWELL drives them, DRIP is the boing.

Surf Spring: three springs driven hard.

AMBIENT

Cloud: a vast soft blur. HAZE and SMEAR.

Bloom: opens up after the note. LENGTH, FEEDBACK.

Shimmer: octaves rising in the tail. SHIFT 1 and 2; feed the INPUT, the TANK or BOTH.

Halo: an octave and a twelfth over a cloud.

Abyss: an octave down and very dark.

Choir: the tail sings back in vowels.

Swell: the reverb, or the dry note, fades in behind each note.

SPECIAL

Nonlinear: swoosh, reverse, ramp, gate, gauss and bounce shapes.

Gated: the eighties drum sound.

Reverse: rises into the note and stops.

Tape Echo: one to six heads, wow and flutter, into a room.

Lo-Fi: crushed, wobbly and gritty.

Resonant: the tail rings on a NOTE and CHORD.

> Every type sits at about the same loudness, so switching types compares sounds, not levels. Save the ones you make with **SAVE**: they appear under YOURS in the preset list and in the preset search.